

Allergy Disclosure & Cross-Contamination Protocol

Company: FreshFork Restaurants | Doc ID: FOH-ALL-003 | Version: 2.0 | Effective: 2026-01-20 | Owner: Culinary & Safety

Purpose & scope

All servers, hosts, and expo staff at FreshFork Restaurants must follow this protocol when a guest discloses a food allergy or asks about ingredients. Applies to dine-in, patio, and takeout with allergy flags in POS.

Key terms

Big 9: Milk, eggs, fish, shellfish, tree nuts, peanuts, wheat, soy, sesame.

Allergy ticket: Kitchen copy printed in red with allergen code; expo verifies before pass.

Cross-contact: Allergen transferred via shared fryer, grill, or utensils — not the same as cross-contamination in manufacturing.

Standard procedure

1. When guest mentions allergy, pause order entry; notify manager if severity stated (anaphylaxis, EpiPen).
2. Read back allergen and all ordered items; never guess — check allergen matrix or ask chef.
3. Enter ALLERGY alert in POS; attach table number and server initials.
4. Confirm with kitchen that dedicated pan / clean gloves used; expo signs allergy ticket.
5. Deliver food yourself when possible; confirm with guest: "This was prepared for your [allergen] allergy."
6. Document incident if reaction suspected — manager completes IR-FOH same shift.

Approved phrases

"Thank you for telling me — I'll note that for the kitchen and double-check every ingredient."

"Our fryer is shared — I want to flag that for your shellfish allergy before you decide on the fries."

"I'll have the chef come out if you'd like to discuss how we handle tree nuts on this line."

"Your plate was prepared separately with clean gloves — please let me know if anything looks wrong."

Scenarios

Scenario A — Peanut allergy, dessert question: Guest orders entrée safely; asks if chocolate cake is safe. Server checks matrix — cake contains almond flour; offers fruit sorbet prepared on separate station.

Scenario B — Gluten-free pasta request: Guest celiac. Server confirms GF pasta boiled in separate water; warns about shared pasta water if kitchen busy — offers salad alternative if risk unacceptable.

Scenario C — Child with dairy allergy: Parents order kids' meal. Server flags allergy ticket, removes cheese from line, confirms butter not used on grill for that ticket only.

Escalation matrix

Situation	Action
Guest reports reaction	Manager + 911 if severe; preserve plate per health dept guide
Kitchen cannot guarantee safety	Manager explains limitation; guest chooses to stay or leave
Guest demands guarantee in writing	Manager only — use approved liability language
Repeat allergy miss on same shift	Stop service; chef retraining same day

Do / Don't

Do: Write allergy on check legibly; carry allergy plates separately; wash hands after handling allergens.

Don't: Say "I'm pretty sure it's fine"; remove croutons and call salad gluten-free without checking dressing; hide allergy from kitchen to speed ticket.